

Clashes on the Prairie



Brainstorm: Why is it important for the government to connect the East to the West?

the United States, Native American has been widely used but is falling out of favor with some groups, and the terms American Indian or indigenous American are preferred by many Native people.

Please note that your textbook uses the term Native American.

Am I Using the Right Word?

So the west begins to be settled..

BUT...



Settling the West

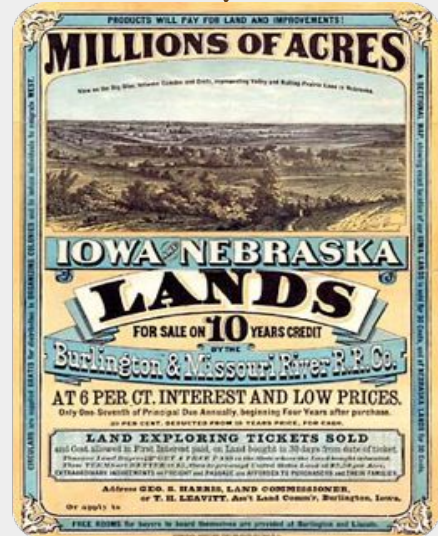
Transcontinental Railroad

- Completed in 1869
- By 1900 there were 5 transcontinental railroads

Homestead Act of 1862

- Need to settle land previously owned by France and Spain...they didn't colonize so its up for grabs!
- **Gov't** has to motivate people to go into the wilderness → dream of “free land”
- Remember...LAND = POWER, Wealth, Freedom
- Gov't provides 160 acres for \$10 → must **cultivate** the land for 5 years (**Why 5 yrs?**)
- Between 1862-1900 600,000 people moved West (many from other countries)

Far & Away Clip

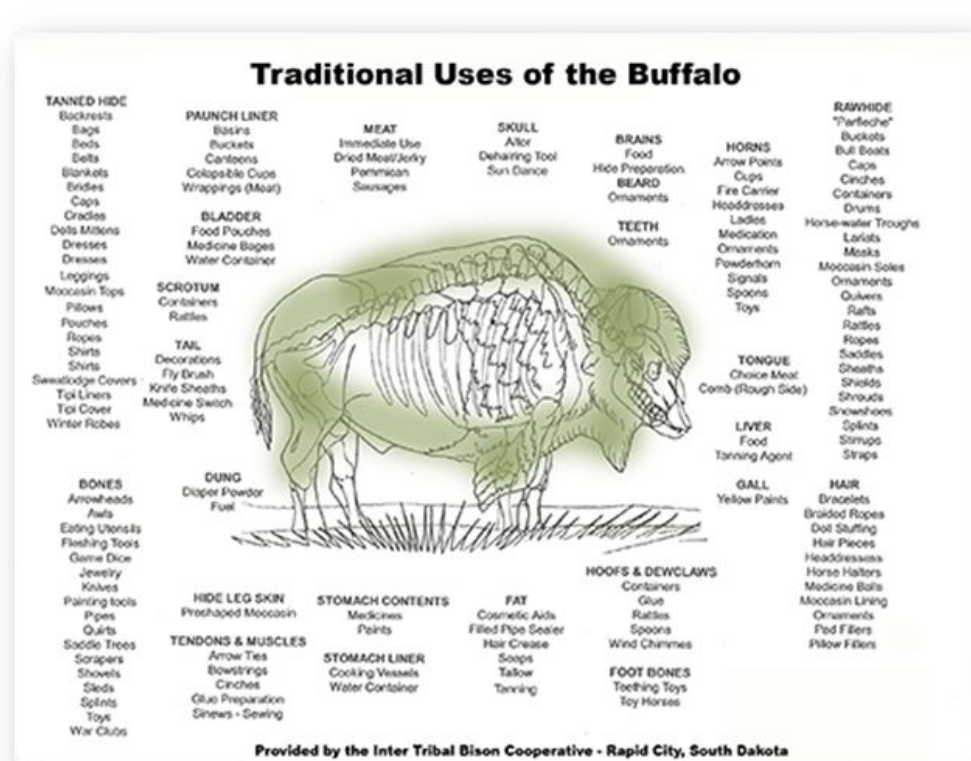


The Horse and the Buffalo



What does the government start to do to the buffalo?

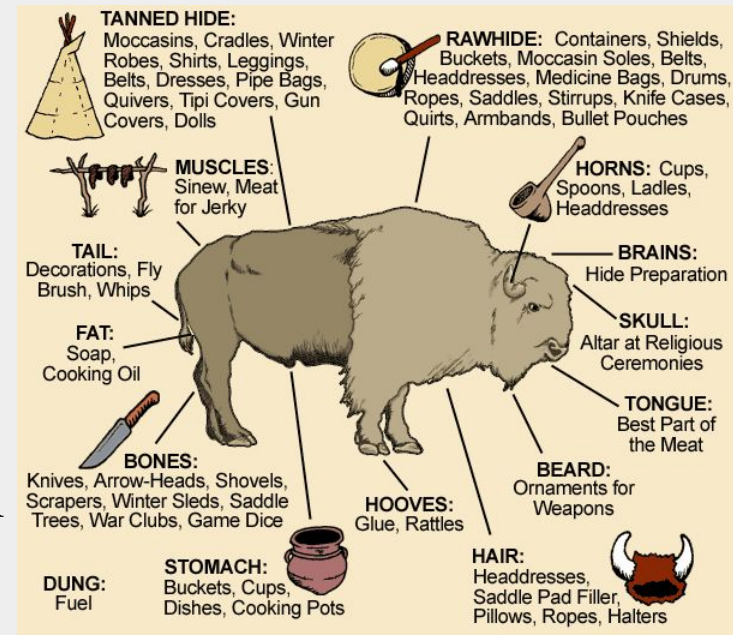
Why?



Without the Buffalo...

- What is their life like? What will they be missing?
- What does the U.S. Government want them to do?

★ This is an important vocabulary word/concept

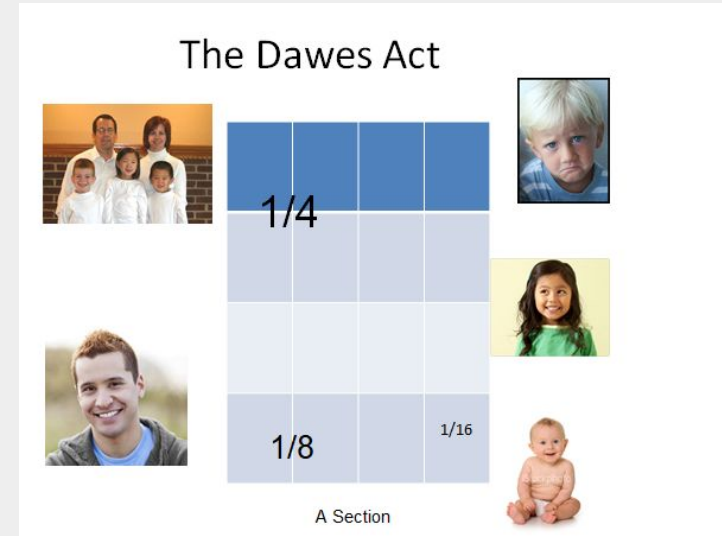


- How do they feel about this?

- Are they going to just go along with this peacefully?
- What do you think happens?

How does the government respond to the American Indian resistance?

- [1887, The Dawes Act Video](#)
 - What does it say?
 - Big thing to understand, what is the government trying to encourage American Indians to do/be?
 - What other benefit does the government get?
- Indian Boarding Schools
 - [Watch this video about the experience of Zitkala Sa \(A Walk in Two worlds\)](#)
 - As you watch the video please take note of things done to the students that would make it more difficult for them to learn their traditional culture.



- ★ Considering 3 things (the killing of the buffalo, the Dawes Act and Indian boarding schools), what is the U.S. government trying to get American Indians to do?
- ★ **Again, this is an important vocabulary word/concept**

The legacy of the clashes on the prairie...

- The “end” of American Indian (the Indian Wars) resistance
 - Dec 28, 1890, The Battle of Wounded Knee
 - [Primary source reading from Dick Fool Bear](#)
 - [Reenactment from the movie *Hidalgo*](#)
 - [Buffalo Bill's Wild West Show Clip](#)
 - How do they portray The Battle of Wounded Knee?



- ★ After watching both clips, what are the biggest differences between what really occurred and how it was portrayed to most Americans?
- ★ What stereotype of American Indians does Buffalo Bill's Wild West Show create?



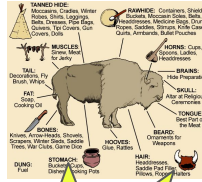
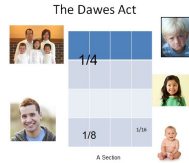
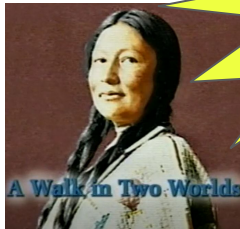
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The government's big goal is **assimilation**

Actions the government takes:

1. Destruction of the buffalo
2. The Dawes Act
3. Boarding schools

Describe what you saw in the video "A Walk in Two Worlds".



- ★ After watching both clips, what are the biggest differences between what really occurred and how it was portrayed to most Americans?
- ★ How do Buffalo Bill's Wild West Shows create the stereotype of an American Indian?